

Κτησίας ὁ Κνίδιος

Ctesias of Cnidus at the Persian Court

eul_aid: ehy

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Ἰωνική](#) [Ionic](#)
Domain: [Ἱατρική](#) [Medicine](#)
Format: [Συναγωγή](#) [Collection](#)

Ctesias of Cnidus was a Greek physician and historian. He served as personal physician to the Persian king Artaxerxes II Mnemon for seventeen years, including during the Battle of Cunaxa in 401 BCE, where he claimed to have treated the king's wound. After his service, he returned to Greece and wrote historical works based on his unique access to the Persian court and archives, though his reliability was questioned even in antiquity.

His major works, written in Ionic Greek, include the *Persica*, a 23-book history of Assyria and Persia preserved in fragments; the *Indica*, a fragmentary account of India's geography and marvels; and the lost geographical work *Periodos* or *Periplus*.

Ctesias is a significant though controversial source for the Greek understanding of the Near East and India. His *Persica* was a major source for later historians, while his *Indica* founded a Western literary tradition of describing India. His works provide valuable evidence for Greek perceptions and the transmission of knowledge, blending possible Persian traditions with Greek literary tropes.

Works (3)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τῆς Ἀσσυρικῆς Ἱστορίας](#) · [Fragments on Assyrian History](#) · 184 passages
- [Ἀπόσπασμα](#) · [On the Colaxaeans](#) · 2 passages
- [Μαρτυρίαι](#) · [Testimonies](#) · 36 passages